

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, early clouds, then partly sunny, breezy and mild in the afternoon, high 59. **Tonight**, mostly clear, low 39. **Tomorrow**, partly cloudy, high 49. Weather map, Page B10.

VOL. CLXXIV . . . No. 60,371 © 2024 The New York Times Company TUESDAY, DECEMBER 17, 2024 Prices in Canada may be higher \$4.00



Soldiers and police officers from the Assad regime turned themselves in Monday to the Turkish-backed group that now leads Syria. IVOR PRICKETT FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

U.S. Employers Of Immigrants Fear an Exodus

By STEVE EDER

Jabil, a major manufacturer of electronics components for the tech industry, made a startling discovery in the spring of 2021: It had been relying on dozens of undocumented workers, contracted from a staffing agency, to power its manufacturing sites near Silicon Valley.

Jabil insisted they be fired, setting off what it called a “mass exodus” from its work force that required expensive and “herculean efforts” to find replacements, including hosting job fairs and borrowing workers from a client.

The upheaval caused the company to fall behind on both existing orders and bids for new business, costing it up to \$50 million, according to interviews and allegations in an ongoing lawsuit against the staffing agency.

How Jabil navigated the sudden loss of undocumented workers — years before Donald J. Trump won re-election on a pledge of mass deportations of illegal immigrants — foreshadows the possible road ahead for companies that rely on staffing agencies to fill jobs at factories, warehouses and distribution centers.

The New York Times reported in November that staffing firms were among the top employers of unauthorized workers at work sites inspected for immigration violations over the past decade. Now with Mr. Trump’s victory, some firms are fearing the worst.

Toby Malara, vice president for government relations at the American Staffing Association, a trade group, said in an interview that the “business community at large” has been urging the incom-

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Democrats Aim to Foil a Constitutional Rewrite

By HEATHER KNIGHT and KATE SELIG

As Republicans prepare to take control of Congress and the White House, among the many scenarios keeping Democrats up at night is an event that many Americans consider a historical relic: a constitutional convention.

The 1787 gathering in Philadelphia to write the Constitution was the one and only time state representatives have convened to work on the document.

But a simple line in the Constitution allows Congress to convene a rewrite session if two-thirds of state legislatures have called for one. The option has never been

Fear That G.O.P. Could Call a Convention and Run Wild

used, but most states have long-forgotten requests on the books that could be enough to trigger a new constitutional convention, some scholars and politicians believe.

Some Democratic officials are more concerned than ever. In California, a Democratic state senator, Scott Wiener, introduced legislation on Monday that would rescind the state’s seven active calls for a constitutional convention,

the first such move since Donald J. Trump’s election to a second term.

Mr. Wiener, who represents San Francisco, and other liberal Democrats believe there is a strong possibility of a “runaway convention.” They say that Republicans could call a convention on the premise, say, of producing an amendment requiring that the federal budget be balanced, then open the door for a free-for-all in which a multitude of other amendments are considered, including some that could restrict abortion access or civil rights.

“I do not want California to inadvertently trigger a constitutional convention that ends up shredding the Constitution,” Mr.

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New Perspective for End of Life

People are turning to psychedelic medicine to address anxiety after a terminal diagnosis. Page D1.

SHURAN HUANG FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Trump and Powell’s Fed Appear Destined for Another Collision

By JEANNA SMIALEK

Inside the halls of the Federal Reserve’s headquarters overlooking Constitution Avenue in Washington, casual mentions of the incoming Trump administration are cautious and infrequent. That’s by design.

Donald J. Trump had a fraught relationship with the politically independent Fed during his first

term. The president wanted central bankers to lower interest rates more aggressively and faster than they thought was economically appropriate.

When officials refused to comply, he blasted them as “boneheads” and an “enemy.” He flirted with trying to fire Jerome H. Powell, the Fed chair. He tried and failed to appoint loyalists to central bank leadership roles.

Interest Rates Likely to Be Source of Tension

As the Fed enters a new Trump term with interest rates higher than they were at any point when he was in office, tensions seem poised to escalate again — and the central bank is on high alert.

Fed analysts try to avoid casually discussing tariffs in email or Microsoft Teams meetings, wary that the information could become public and make the Fed look anti-Trump, according to one staff economist who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss the sensitive matter.

Hallway chatter has taken a negative tone but is often stud-

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Shipping Goes Back in Time
Rounding the tip of Africa used to be rare, but freighters avoiding the Suez have reverted to an old route. PAGE B1

Amazon Injuries Tied to Quotas
A staff report by the Senate labor panel uncovered evidence of the company’s internal concern about safety. PAGE B1

INTERNATIONAL A4-9

From Doctor to ‘Date Girl’
Nearly four years into a grinding civil war, Myanmar’s economy is in ruins, and people — even professionals with degrees — are desperate. PAGE A4

U.S. Loses South Korean Ally
The impeached President Yoon Suk Yeol shifted his country closer to Washington and stood up to Beijing. PAGE A6

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From Pacific Rim to M.L.B.
The scouting process in Japan, Korea and Taiwan is streamlined, but it brings few players to the majors. PAGE B6



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Ballet Troupe in Drag Turns 50
The Trocks, with Sergio Najera, above, have been interested in comedy, not making political statements. PAGE C1

When Jazz Greats Converged
Art Kane’s “Harlem 1958” gathered the genre’s giants. Sonny Rollins, 94, looks back at the historic picture. PAGE C1

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Trump’s Conviction Upheld
Justice Juan M. Merchan rejected the president-elect’s argument that the Supreme Court’s recent ruling on presidential immunity had nullified his hush-money case in New York. PAGE A11

Turning Against Their Mayor
Residents of a fast-growing city in Utah voted overwhelmingly to rein in the powers of a mayor who they say has a penchant for secrecy and is overly deferential to developers. PAGE A10

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SCIENCE TIMES D1-8

Making Milking Safer
On America’s dairy farms, the potential for disease transmission is worrying, health experts say. Farmers are taking steps to reduce the risk. PAGE D8

